which is carried into the lung-tissues by the pulmonary artery from the right ventricle of the heart. At this point the blood is finally collected by the veins from all portions of the system, and, being charged with the impurities and effete matters, gathered up in traversing the body, presents the appearance of a dark purple, almost black, fluid, when poured through the right vena cava or large vein into the heart. By the exposure of the venous blood to the oxygen of the atmosphere inhaled through the lungs, its impurities are in part disengaged and given off in the form of carbonic acid gas; the whole mass of blood, or nearly the whole, becomes changed in tone and color; the dark purple hue is converted into a bright scarlet, and by the time the pulmonary circulation is completed, the blood is arterialized and poured back into the heart through the left auricle, in a condition sufficiently renovated to form pabulum for the support and nourishment of the entire system.

We must now trace in more detail the circulatory process, and note the intimate connection and interdependence which it maintains with the respiratory system. The heart is the centre of the circulatory apparatus, and it is situated in the thorax, between the right and left lungs. The point or apex slants forward toward the left lung, on which it slightly impinges, the base or broad part inclining backward and upward toward the right shoulder. Although the formation of muscular fibre is uniform in all parts of the system, the closely-knit and strongly-packed fibres of the heart constitute it the